

Own the IMDS desk. Build the agentic workflow.

From a 5,000-MDS backlog and OEM-specific rejects (GM, VW, Ford) to same-day accept and zero PPAP delay — with an internally built auto-accept / auto-reject workflow. No software budget.

PRESENTED BY

Supplier Quality Director

AUDIENCE

VP / GM · Operations,
Supply Chain, Quality, HR

OUR ROLE

Tier-1 and Tier-2 supplier

CUSTOMERS IN SCOPE

GM · VW · Ford

TODAY'S ASK

Endorse Supplier Quality as accountable owner of an internally led build. Give air cover to automate our own IMDS company account. Recognize this as the house approach to a production-gate problem hiring cannot solve.

The IMDS desk is a production gate run as a manual inbox

Facts as of this briefing. No Examiner, no IMDS Plus, no Connect, no third-party platform.

50

MDS received / day

Inbound volume that must be viewed before any accept or reject

~5,000

Open outstanding MDS

Structural backlog — ~100 working days of intake if inbound froze

0

Automation in place

Classic IMDS browser only. Every node is a human click.

GM / VW /

Reject chaos driver

Ford

OEM overlays on top of Rec 001 — not the IMDS system check

Operations

An accepted MDS is a PPAP prerequisite. Open MDS = open production authorization. Zero PPAP delay is the target, not a slogan.

Supply chain

We sit in two hops at once: Tier-2 to our customer and Tier-1 to the OEM. Dummy or unaccepted child MDS blocks the whole tree.

Quality

Passing IMDS Check is not OEM acceptance. IMDS 15.2 says further manual review may be required. GM, VW, and Ford each add naming, weight, and structure rules.

HR

Judgment sits in a few specialists' heads. Leave or peak volume stalls launches. The answer is to encode OEM rule packs — not to hire a parallel inbox.

IMDS is the industry mechanism behind ELV, GADSL, and PPAP

What the room must share as language

- ▶ IMDS (International Material Data System) is the OEM-mandated repository for every material in a finished vehicle. DXC administers it. Basic browser access is free; we use only that today.
- ▶ An MDS is a tree: component / semi-component → material → basic substance (CAS, 1 g resolution). Every node must sum to 100%. Rec 001 is the structure and quality bible (10% wildcard cap, legal node types, polymer marking, application codes).
- ▶ IMDS was built for the ELV Directive. It also carries GADSL (P / D / D/P), REACH SVHC, and, since IMDS 15, PCF fields (Rec 027). We are not asking for PCF in v1.
- ▶ Most OEMs will not grant PPAP without an accepted MDS for that part number. A rejected MDS is a launch delay.

Material / Tier-3

Propose child MDS to us

Us as customer

View → accept or reject. Only accepted children may be attached.

Us as supplier

Build our tree. Propose or Send to next customer.

GM / VW / Ford

Accept into the vehicle. ELV / GADSL / PPAP.

Every MDS we touch is one of six actions — all of them are chaotic today

1 Verify inbox

Filter received: not yet browsed, browsed, in process, cancelled by sender. 50/day plus 5,000 open.

2 View / analyse

Mandatory before accept or reject. Walk the tree vs BOM/drawing. Rec 001 + OEM overlay.

3 Accept

Irreversible in the browser. Then the child can be attached to our MDS.

4 Reject

Requires a usable reason. Vague Rec 001 text creates another bad version.

5 Forward

Only after accept, and only if the creator allowed forwarding. Directed-buy pattern.

6 Propose / Send

Hand our assembled MDS to the next customer. Version rules differ — get this wrong and GM/VW/Ford bounce it.

Rec 001 is the floor. GM, VW, and Ford are why first-pass yield dies.

This is the failure mode. Not typing speed. Not “the IMDS check turned green.”

Layer	What it checks	If we only do this	What the OEM still rejects
IMDS Check	Completeness, some Rec 001 arithmetic	Necessary	IMDS 15.2: further review may be required
Rec 001	Tree legality, 100% nodes, 10% wildcard, ranges, names	Industry baseline	Material class, polymer marking, application codes still judged
GM overlay	GM IMDS reporting + GMW3059 substance rules	GM-specific	Part naming, weight window, org unit, published-MDS policy
VW overlay	VW 91101 and Konzern IMDS instructions	VW-specific	Structure/sibling rules, recipient data, plant org ID
Ford overlay	Ford RSMS + IMDS reporting guide	Ford-specific	Supplier code / part number pairing, legacy flags, Propose vs Send

v1 IP is three Examiner-equivalent packs: GM, VW, Ford — applied on inbound accept/reject and on outbound Propose. That is how we get to 100% first-pass toward the OEM. One generic Rec 001 bot will not.

Hiring cannot drain 5,000. The math does not allow it.

50 / day

New MDS into the inbox

Must be viewed before accept or reject

5,000 open

Outstanding stock

Equals ~100 days of intake if inbound stopped

~106 / day

Decisions needed to drain in 90 days

50 new + 5,000/90. Agents, not overtime.

Action	Time per MDS (typical)	At 50 new / day	What breaks at 5,000 open
Inbox verify	1–2 min	45–90 min	Aging, VIP OEM parts, cancelled-by-sender noise
View + Rec 001 + OEM pack	8–20 min simple; 30–60 complex	Most of the shift	This is the bottleneck. Nodes, not MDS count.
Accept	1–3 min after review	Cheap	Irreversible. Wrongful accept is the Quality risk.
Reject + usable reason	5–15 min	High if OEM rules fire	Reason quality determines whether version N+1 is clean.
Forward / Propose / Send	2–5 min + 20–90 min assemble	Outbound to GM/VW/Ford	Recipient data and version policy. Instant OEM bounce if wrong.

v1 decides: auto-accept greens, auto-reject reds, humans on novel cases

An agent pursues a goal — same-day inbox to a defined quality bar — with tools, memory, and a kill switch. Not a nightly spreadsheet.

GREEN · auto-accept

- ▶ Rec 001 arithmetic clean
- ▶ No IMDS Check errors
- ▶ Matching GM or VW or Ford pack
- ▶ Known-good supplier / material IDs
- ▶ Weight inside the OEM window
- ▶ Logged with rule-pack version

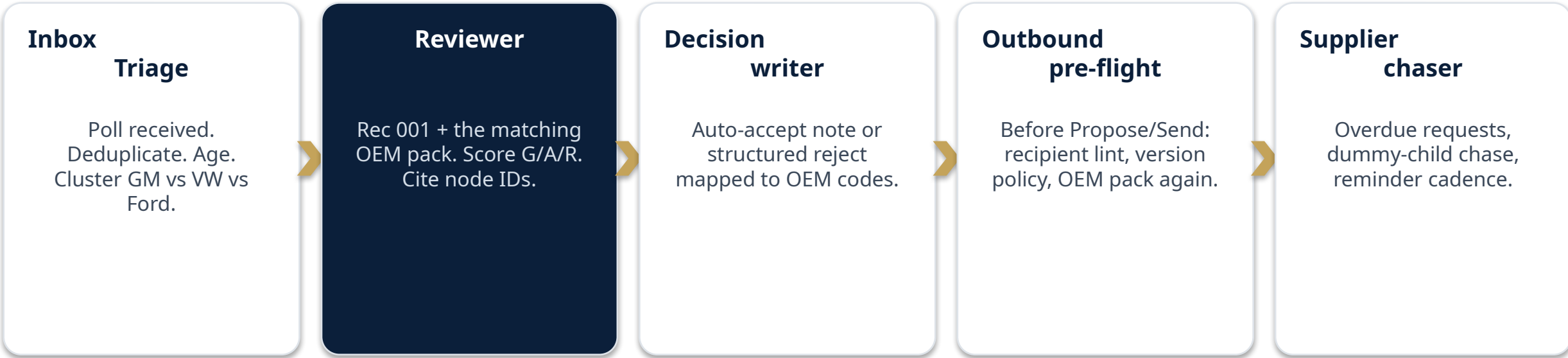
RED · auto-reject

- ▶ GADSL P / illegal heavy-metal code
- ▶ Dummy or unaccepted child node
- ▶ Illegal tree / mixed siblings where OEM forbids
- ▶ Send used where Propose is required
- ▶ Part number / supplier code mismatch
- ▶ Structured reject text, node-cited

HUMAN · do not automate

- ▶ New chemistry / classification call
- ▶ OEM derogation or dispute
- ▶ Conflicting measured vs calculated weight near limit
- ▶ Directed-buy / forwarding edge cases
- ▶ Policy change (new GADSL / Rec)
- ▶ Kill-switch and sample audit of greens

What we will build — five agents on our own IMDS account



How we touch IMDS

v1: attended/unattended automation of OUR company IMDS session only — our credentials, our inbox/outbox. No other company’s data. No marketplace scraping. IMDS Connect is a later paid option, not required to start.

System of record we own

GM / VW / Ford rule packs, labeled accept/reject history, rule-pack version on every decision, kill switch. That file is the IP.

What we will not build in v1

CAMDS. PCF / Catena-X. A purchased IMDS Plus license. A vendor platform. Those can wait until the desk is under control.

The market proves the prize. We still build — \$0, our OEM mix, our IP.

Vendor figures below are vendor-reported. We keep them as evidence the problem is solvable. They are not a purchase recommendation.

Market proof (not a shopping list)

- ▶ DXC IMDS Plus / Inbox Automation: Examiner profiles, auto-accept if no errors. Paid. We have none of it.
- ▶ iPoint / Assent, APA MDS Xpress: enterprise IMDS platforms. Not in our estate.
- ▶ Predco (vendor-reported): –89% rejects, –72% cycle, ~18 days PPAP recovery, 1.8% reject rate across 12 Tier-1s.
- ▶ Certivo (vendor-reported): 30–40% first-pass reject → <5%; 4–6 weeks → ~4 hours; 80% less prep labor.
- ▶ Tetra Tech: draft trees from drawings/photos — supplier-engagement aid, not our inbox engine.

Why leadership should fund effort, not software

- ▶ Budget is own effort. No license, no integrator, no platform RFP.
- ▶ Nothing is installed today. Buying Plus or iPoint is a second program, not a shortcut to GM/VW/Ford packs.
- ▶ The scarce asset is labeled decisions and three OEM overlays — that knowledge already sits in Supplier Quality.
- ▶ A vendor does not know our tree conventions. We do.
- ▶ We will reuse vendor ideas (score, cite, structured reject, pre-flight). We will not rent the desk.

Auto-accept is allowed. Uncontrolled auto-accept is not.

Control	Owner	What it prevents
Rule-pack version stamped on every accept/reject	Supplier Quality	Orphan decisions after a GADSL or OEM-guide change
Kill switch — halt auto-accept / auto-reject in one action	Quality + SQ Director	A bad pack promoting into production
Sample audit of greens (daily at start, then weekly)	Quality	Silent wrongful-accept drift
Human-mandatory list (novel chemistry, derogation, dispute)	SQ Director	Liability and customer relationship sitting on a bot
Own-account only — our IMDS credentials, our company	IT / SQ	Any appearance of accessing another company's IMDS data
Role redesign: specialists own OEM packs and amber/novel	HR + SQ Director	Framing this as a headcount cut instead of a skill shift

HR: the desk does not disappear. The job becomes OEM-rule ownership, exception judgment, and supplier coaching. That is the only staffing model that survives a 5,000-MDS backlog without a hiring wave.

Program targets we will manage to — and what 90 days actually delivers

100% first-pass, same-day accept, and zero PPAP delay are the operating contract. The 5,000 stock is a drain plan, not a day-1 miracle.

100%

First-pass yield to OEM

Outbound MDS to GM / VW / Ford pre-flighted against that OEM pack before Propose

Same day

Request-to-accept on NEW MDS

Green auto-accept the day it arrives. Red auto-reject the same day with a cited reason.

Zero

PPAP delays from IMDS

No launch waits on an unaccepted or bouncing MDS for parts in this scope.

DAYS 1-30

Instrument

Log every manual accept/reject with reason. Freeze v0 GM/VW/Ford checklists. Gold-label 200 historical MDS. No auto-decision yet.

DAYS 31-60

Auto-reject live

Red patterns fire with structured text. Greens scored in shadow beside the specialist. Precision review twice weekly.

DAYS 61-90

Auto-accept live

Greens auto-accept with audit sample. Outbound pre-flight before Propose. Start draining the 5,000 at a measured daily burn-down.

Endorse the build. Name the owner. Give air cover.

1

Endorse

Adopt an internally led agentic IMDS workflow as the house approach for GM, VW, and Ford MDS — not a vendor RFP, not “hire more inbox.”

2

Accountable owner

Supplier Quality Director owns the rule packs, the kill switch, the 90-day milestones, and the weekly burn-down of the 5,000.

3

Air cover

Permit automation of our own IMDS company account (our users, our data only) so auto-accept / auto-reject can run without a DXC license in v1.

4

Function support

Quality: sample audit. Operations: PPAP clock as the success metric. Supply chain: supplier chase on dummy children. HR: rewrite the specialist role to OEM-rule owner.

This is already scoped, already owned, and already costed at zero software spend. What Supplier Quality is asking for is leadership recognition of that standard — and the authority to run it.

Glossary and v0 OEM checklists

Reference for Q&A. Validate against current GM / VW / Ford IMDS portals before production use.

Term	Meaning	Term	Meaning
Air cover	Leadership backs SQ to automate without reopening buy/hire every week.	Parallel inbox	Hire more people to do the same manual view/accept/reject work.
PCF	Product Carbon Footprint — emissions per part (Rec 027; not in v1).	Directed buy	OEM nominates sub-supplier; lower tier Proposes to OEM and to you.
Overlay	OEM-specific rules on top of Rec 001 + IMDS Check.	Deduplicate	One queue item per real MDS — no double-processing resends.
Age	Time in status; prioritize VIP OEM parts and SLA risk.	Dummy child	Placeholder node instead of accepted sub-supplier MDS.
Score / cite	Rate green/amber/red; flag exact tree node and field.	Structured reject	Templated, coded reason — not “check Rec 001.”
Pre-flight	Run OEM pack on outbound MDS before Propose/Send.	Orphan decision	Accept/reject with no rule-pack version on record.
Amber / novel	Uncertain or new case — human decides, bot does not.	OEM-rule owner	Specialist owns GM/VW/Ford packs, not inbox volume.

v0 pre-Propose checklist — encode into Reviewer agent (days 1–30)

GM	VW	Ford
▶ Propose (not Send); internally released ▶ Correct GM org unit / plant recipient ▶ Part number + description on recipient tab ▶ Weight within GM tolerance; GMW3059 clean ▶ Forwarding allowed if pass-through; no dummy children	▶ VW 91101 + Konzern IMDS instructions ▶ Correct plant / org ID on recipient ▶ Part naming per VW guide; sibling rules ▶ Polymer marking / process fields if required ▶ VW pack pre-flight — no reds before Propose	▶ Ford RSMS substance compliance ▶ Supplier code + part number pairing ▶ Legacy / EOP flags if applicable ▶ Correct Ford org unit; tree vs BOM ▶ Ford pack pre-flight — no reds before Propose

Predco vendor-reported (–89% rejects, –72% cycle): industry proof only — not our ROI. HR: role shifts from inbox clerk to OEM-rule owner + exception judgment.